

## MD-0004: Adoption of the VIDS Governance Handbook v1.0

| Field         | Value                                                                         |
|---------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ID            | MD-0004                                                                       |
| Type          | MD, Maintainer Decision                                                       |
| Status        | Accepted                                                                      |
| Normative?    | No. Adopts an operating handbook; changes no dataset conformance requirement. |
| Visibility    | Public (standard governance)                                                  |
| Proposed date | 2026-07-22                                                                    |
| Accepted date | 2026-07-26                                                                    |
| Deciders      | Steering Committee / maintainers (Princeton Medical Systems)                  |
| Related       | GOVERNANCE.md; MD-0002; SOP-VIDS-Governance-Handbook-v1.0; REG-DOC            |

### Decision

The VIDS Governance Handbook v1.0 is adopted as an Active SOP-class artifact. It supersedes the "VIDS Committee Handbook" draft of the same version line, whose pre-adoption clarifications are carried forward below. Adoption authorizes the member-facing edition and its distribution to Committee and Council members after acceptance of appointment, per the Handbook's own Distribution field, with the member edition marked "Confidential: for Council and Committee members (Section 12)" in place of the draft's internal-distribution footer.

### Pre-adoption corrections (applied to the adopted text)

- Time expectations per quarter.** Advisory Council 2 to 4 hours per quarter; Steering Committee 4 to 6 hours per quarter. Applied in both the quick-reference page and Section 6. Corrects the per-month figures in the draft source, aligning with the finalized commitment and the quarterly cadence.
- Advisory Council recusal semantics** (carried forward from Committee Handbook 9.2). Added to Section 11: "For Advisory Council matters, recusal means stepping back from the Council's advisory recommendation or opinion on that item. The member may continue to contribute relevant expertise unless the chair determines otherwise."
- Publication venue for membership** (carried forward from Committee Handbook 10.1). Section 12 "Always public" membership entry reads: membership of both bodies (names and affiliations), with each member's consent at appointment, may be published on the VIDS website and other official project communications.
- Confidentiality of prospective invitations** (carried forward from Committee Handbook 10.2). Added to Section 12 "Confidential": "Prospective membership. Prospective member invitations and candidate identities remain confidential until an invitation has been accepted or the individual has agreed to public disclosure."
- Section 13 welcome-packet contents aligned to the actual package.** The onboarding packet description reads: handbook, Governance Charter and Document Index, current Specification, relevant decision records. Minutes are removed from the description; the package carries a curated decision-records snapshot, not minutes.

Corrections 2 through 4 preserve clarifications negotiated during the first Advisory Council appointment; adopting the successor edition without them would silently regress terms already relied upon by a seated member. Correction 5 makes the handbook describe what members actually receive.

### Consequences

- The member edition (VIDS-Governance-Handbook-v1.0, Member Edition PDF) is generated from the adopted text and encloses in the Advisory Council welcome package.
- Onboarding-form citations re-anchor to the adopted edition's numbering: conflict-of-interest disclosure to Section 11, confidentiality acknowledgment to Section 12, written acknowledgment to Section 14.
- REG-DOC gains an SOP row for the Handbook (the first registered SOP), status Active on acceptance of this decision.
- The SOP markdown source of record is synchronized with the adopted text, including the corrections above, with a revision-history entry citing this decision.
- The "VIDS Committee Handbook" edition is retired; no further copies are distributed.

## Scope note

This is a project-operations decision. The Handbook explains how governance operates; it creates no conformance requirement, and nothing in it modifies the Core Specification.

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## Sign-off

| Maintainer        | Decision | Approval date |
|-------------------|----------|---------------|
| Dr. Joan S. Muthu | Approved | 2026-07-26    |
| John Shalen R.    | Approved | 2026-07-26    |

**Approval evidence:** MD-0004-ApprovalEvidence-2026-07-26.pdf

## Change log

| Date       | Change                                                          |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2026-07-22 | Initial draft (Proposed).                                       |
| 2026-07-26 | Accepted following approval by Joan S. Muthu and John Shalen R. |

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*MD-0004 is a governance-process decision. It is non-normative with respect to dataset conformance.*